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TAB 24



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-137-23/24, **Version:** 1

2024 Advocacy Agenda

December 12, 2023

Office of Government Relations

Action Proposed:

Authorize the Office of Government Relations (OGR), on behalf of Los Angeles Unified, to sponsor legislation and proactively advocate for policies and funding proposals at the local, state and federal levels that are consistent with the District's 2022-26 Strategic Plan.

Background:

Each year OGR presents to the Board proposed advocacy priorities for the upcoming year. This includes securing authors for legislation, advocating for changes/inclusion in budget and funding proposals, and taking positions on related bills, regulatory changes, and policy issues as presented on the attached documents. Given the unprecedented challenges the District has faced in recent years, it will be important to build in flexibility to authorize the Office of Government Relations to pursue the necessary advocacy on other policy and funding priorities as new issues arise in 2024.

Expected Outcomes:

The approved policy and funding priorities will result in a coherent advocacy agenda that the Office of Government Relations will promote and advance by building local, state, and federal coalitions with a diverse set of education partners.

Board Options and Consequences:

Approval will allow OGR staff to proceed in a timely manner to secure authors for District-sponsored legislation and pursue advocacy at the various levels of government. Delay in approval will negatively impact the OGR's staff ability to secure authors for District-sponsored legislation prior to the legislative deadlines for the introduction of bills.

Policy Implications:

The legislative proposals and advocacy priorities support existing Board policies and are in alignment with the District's 2022-26 Strategic Plan.

Budget Impact:

Costs of the advocacy efforts are borne by Office of Government Relations within the existing general fund budget.

Student Impact:

The advocacy agenda supports students and their academic achievement either directly or indirectly through legislation, funding and policies. Advocacy on behalf of the Los Angeles Unified community is critical to the success of students, teachers and administrators, and the advancement of our schools.

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Equity Impact:

Not Applicable

Issues and Analysis:

Not Applicable

Attachments:

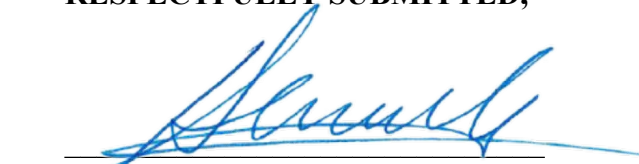
Attachment A: LAUSD 2024 Advocacy Agenda

Attachment B: Office of Government Relations 2023-24 Policy and Guiding Principles

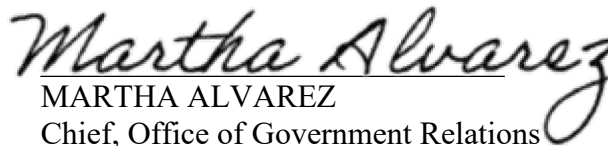
Submitted:

11/14/2023

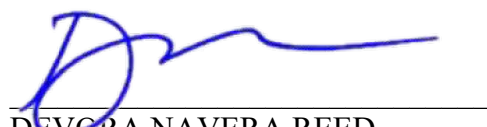
RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


MARTHA ALVAREZ
Chief, Office of Government Relations
Office of Government Relations

REVIEWED BY:


DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel☒ Approved as to form.

REVIEWED BY:


NOLBERTO DELGADILLO
Deputy Chief Business Officer, Finance☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.



Los Angeles Unified School District

2024 ADVOCACY AGENDA

ADVOCACY PRIORITIES

The Los Angeles Unified School District's (Los Angeles Unified) legislative and funding priorities call for policies that make schools safe, welcoming, and equitable places for learning. The 2024 Advocacy Agenda is aligned to Los Angeles Unified's 2022-26 Strategic Plan and the District's Advocacy Guiding Principles and Priorities. In addition to the issues identified below, the Office of Government Relations supports and advocates for legislative proposals and initiatives that are consistent with the Strategic Plan and will pursue necessary policies and funding in 2024 as new issues arise.

LOCAL

The Office of Government Relations, in collaboration with other District departments, will explore opportunities for partnerships with local municipalities serving District schools to address the following:

- Strengthen intergovernmental collaboration to expand the District's enrollment campaign efforts and support school-aged children who are not enrolled or attending school, including disadvantaged populations such as homeless, foster and newcomer students.
- Support efforts to combat the synthetic opioid crisis.
- Increase low- to no-cost transportation opportunities for students through a continued partnership with LA Metro's GoPass Fareless Pass and other local transit agencies.
- Increase crossing guard funding and support outreach efforts to ensure the timely hiring of these positions.
- Strengthen partnership with Los Angeles County to unify mental health funding and staffing to provide consistent services for schools and communities in high-need areas.
- Increase resources to support a positive school climate and safe routes to and from schools.
- Support efforts aimed at the relocation or closure of the Atlas facility site in Watts, and explore funding opportunities for site clean-up.
- Expand joint-use facilities agreements and programming for students through continued partnerships with regional Recreation and Parks departments.
- Establish municipal education compacts with local governments.

STATE

The Office of Government Relations will pursue the following statewide legislation and budget priorities:

Sponsored Legislation

- Make Kindergarten a mandatory grade level to close opportunity gaps amongst the youngest learners.
- Base funding for local education agencies on total student enrollment, rather than average daily attendance.
- Authorize local educational agencies to permit students to carry naloxone on campus with their parent or guardian's permission.

- Codify flexibilities for students attending schools with alternative “block” schedules to meet the physical education (PE) minute requirements.
- Extend authorization to operate single gender schools at Los Angeles Unified.
- Pursue permanent authorization for the Office of the Inspector General, which supports the District’s operational effectiveness.
- Pursue inflationary adjustments to statutory cost limits for small dollar school construction and maintenance projects.

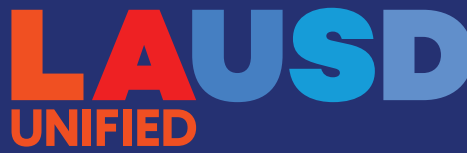
State Budget Priorities

- Advocate for increased ongoing investments through the Local Control Funding Formula.
- Support maximum flexibility of new one-time or ongoing Proposition 98 funding.
- Continue to advocate for flexibilities in the Expanded Learning Opportunities Program to better serve all students.
- Advocate for flexibility and relief from penalties during universal transitional kindergarten expansion.
- Support investments in school facilities construction, modernization, and greening projects.
- Maintain and expand funding for special education services.
- Pursue other technical clarifications and flexibilities as necessary.

FEDERAL

The Office of Government Relations will continue to advocate for the following issues at the federal level:

- Additional funding to increase access to high-quality preschool programs for all 3- and 4-year olds, including support for increased reimbursement rates, teacher preparation programs, and facilities renovations.
- Passage of the bipartisan IDEA Full Funding Act to increase spending for special education to the full 40 percent financial commitment.
- Increase connectivity funding to provide students and teachers access to devices and internet services for off-campus use and support changes to the E-Rate program to use funds to strengthen IT security infrastructure.
- Increase appropriations for Title I, Title II, Title III, English Language Acquisition Grants, Title IV, Magnet Schools Assistance grants and other education funding programs.
- Funding to address substance abuse and recovery support services for students.
- Protection and support of immigrant students and families, including support for permanent legal protections and a pathway to citizenship for undocumented youth.
- Flexibilities for school nutrition programs to enable continued free, nutritious meals for all children.
- Adoption of a school construction bill to increase financial support for school facilities and greening projects.
- Funding to address educator shortages, improve training and supports for school staff, and increased educator diversity.
- Funding to meet the mental health needs of our students, school staff, and teachers by increasing the number of school-based counselors, psychologists, social workers, and other health professionals.



Distrito Escolar Unificado de Los Ángeles

AGENDA PARA LA PROMOCIÓN DE INICIATIVAS EN 2024

PRIORIDADES DE PROMOCIÓN

Las prioridades legislativas y de financiamiento del Distrito Escolar Unificado de Los Ángeles (Distrito Unificado de Los Ángeles) requieren políticas que hagan que las escuelas sean lugares seguros, acogedores y equitativos para el aprendizaje. La Agenda para la Promoción de Iniciativas en 2024 se alineó al Plan Estratégico 2022-26 del Distrito Escolar Unificado de Los Ángeles y los Principios Rectores y Prioridades para la Promoción de Iniciativas del Distrito. Además de los asuntos que se identifican a continuación, la Oficina de Relaciones Gubernamentales apoya y aboga por propuestas e iniciativas de ley que sean coherentes con el Plan Estratégico y promoverá las políticas y el financiamiento necesarios en 2024 a medida que vayan surgiendo nuevos asuntos.

LOCAL

La Oficina de Relaciones Gubernamentales, en colaboración con otros departamentos del Distrito, explorará las oportunidades de asociarse con los municipios locales que prestan servicios a las escuelas del Distrito a fin de abordar lo siguiente:

- Fortalecer la colaboración intergubernamental para ampliar los esfuerzos de la campaña de inscripción del Distrito, y apoyar a los niños en edad escolar que no estén inscritos o que no estén asistiendo a la escuela, incluidas las poblaciones desfavorecidas como los estudiantes sin hogar, los estudiantes en adopción temporal y los recién llegados.
- Apoyar los esfuerzos para combatir la crisis de opioides sintéticos.
- Aumentar las oportunidades de transporte de bajo costo o sin costo para los estudiantes a través de una asociación continua con GoPass Fareless Pass de LA Metro y otras agencias de transporte locales.
- Aumentar la financiación de los guardias de cruce y apoyar la labor de divulgación para garantizar la contratación oportuna de estos puestos.
- Fortalecer la asociación con el condado de Los Ángeles para unificar los fondos y la dotación de personal de salud mental con el objetivo de brindar servicios consistentes a las escuelas y comunidades en áreas de alta necesidad.
- Aumentar los recursos para apoyar un clima escolar positivo y las rutas seguras de ida y de regreso a las escuelas.
- Apoyar los esfuerzos dirigidos a la reubicación o el cierre de las instalaciones de Atlas en Watts, y explorar oportunidades de financiamiento para la limpieza del sitio.
- Ampliar los acuerdos de instalaciones de uso conjunto y la programación para los estudiantes a través de asociaciones continuas con los departamentos regionales de Recreación y Parques.
- Establecer acuerdos educativos municipales con los gobiernos locales.

ESTADO

La Oficina de Relaciones Gubernamentales promoverá las siguientes prioridades legislativas y presupuestarias a nivel estatal:

Legislación patrocinada

- Hacer que el Kindergarten sea un nivel de grado obligatorio para cerrar las brechas de oportunidades entre los estudiantes más jóvenes.
- Basar los fondos para las agencias locales de educación en el total de estudiantes matriculados, en lugar del promedio de la asistencia diaria.
- Autorizar que las agencias locales de educación permitan que los estudiantes lleven naloxona al plantel escolar, con el permiso de sus padres o tutores.

- Codificar flexibilidades para los estudiantes que asisten a escuelas con horarios alternativos de "bloques" a fin de que puedan cumplir con los minutos requeridos de Educación Física (PE).
- Extender la autorización para operar escuelas de un solo género en el Distrito Escolar Unificado de Los Ángeles.
- Promover la autorización permanente de la Oficina del Inspector General, que apoya la eficacia operativa del Distrito.
- Promover los ajustes inflacionarios a los límites legales de los costos para los proyectos de construcción y mantenimiento de escuelas pequeñas.

Prioridades del presupuesto estatal

- Promover el aumento de las inversiones continuas a través de la Fórmula de Financiamiento de Control Local.
- Apoyar la máxima flexibilidad de los nuevos fondos de la Proposición 98 financiados una sola vez o continuamente.
- Continuar abogando por tener flexibilidad en el Programa de Ampliación de Oportunidades de Aprendizaje a fin de brindar un mejor servicio a todos los estudiantes.
- Abogar por la flexibilidad y la exención de las sanciones durante la expansión del Kindergarten Universal de Transición.
- Apoyar las inversiones en proyectos de construcción, modernización y ecologización de instalaciones escolares.
- Mantener y ampliar los fondos para los servicios de educación especial.
- Promover otras aclaraciones técnicas y flexibilidades según sea necesario.

FEDERAL

La Oficina de Relaciones Gubernamentales continuará abogando por los siguientes temas a nivel federal:

- Fondos adicionales para aumentar el acceso a programas preescolares de alta calidad para todos los niños de 3 y 4 años, incluido el apoyo para aumentar las tasas de reembolso, los programas de preparación de maestros y la renovación de instalaciones.
- Aprobación de la Ley bipartidista de Financiamiento Completo de IDEA para aumentar al 40 por ciento el compromiso económico total para gastos de educación especial.
- Aumentar los fondos de conectividad para proporcionar a los estudiantes y maestros acceso a dispositivos y servicios de Internet para uso fuera del plantel escolar, y apoyar los cambios en el programa E-Rate para usar los fondos con el fin de fortalecer la infraestructura de seguridad de la Tecnología de la Información (IT, por sus siglas en inglés).
- Aumentar las asignaciones para el Título I, el Título II, el Título III, las Subvenciones para la Adquisición del Idioma Inglés, el Título IV, las subvenciones de Asistencia para Escuelas Magnet y otros programas de financiación de la educación.
- Fondos para abordar el abuso de sustancias y los servicios de apoyo para la recuperación de los estudiantes.
- Protección y apoyo a los estudiantes y las familias inmigrantes, incluido el apoyo de las protecciones legales permanentes y un camino hacia la ciudadanía para los jóvenes indocumentados.
- Flexibilidades para los programas de nutrición escolar que permitan la continuidad de las comidas nutritivas y gratuitas para todos los niños.
- Adopción de un proyecto de ley de construcción de escuelas para aumentar el apoyo financiero a las instalaciones escolares y proyectos ecológicos.
- Fondos para abordar la escasez de educadores, mejorar la capacitación y el apoyo para el personal escolar, y aumentar la diversidad de los educadores.
- Fondos para satisfacer las necesidades de salud mental de nuestros estudiantes, personal escolar y maestros mediante el aumento del número de consejeros, psicólogos, trabajadores sociales y otros profesionales de la salud en las escuelas.



Office of Government Relations 2023-24 Policy and Guiding Principles

As the second largest school district in the nation, the Los Angeles Unified School District (Los Angeles Unified) serves a diverse community of more than 500,000 students in pre-kindergarten through Adult Education. Los Angeles Unified families speak 98 languages in their households. Over 86 percent of our students are identified as low-income, English Learner, and/or in the foster care system. These students demonstrate extraordinary resilience and persistence, constantly striving to overcome the challenges they face. Supporting the academic achievement and social-emotional well-being of students, and closing educational equity gaps, requires strong partnerships with federal, state, and local governments.

The Office of Government Relations (OGR) informs the Board and the Superintendent of legislative developments and opportunities and responds to advocacy priorities identified by the Board, the Superintendent and District staff. These policy and guiding principles frame the advocacy and engagement that OGR undertakes on behalf of Los Angeles Unified. The following principles outline areas that guide OGR's work when evaluating legislation or funding proposals introduced by governmental entities, particularly the California Legislature.

GUIDING PRINCIPLES

Los Angeles Unified's principles are guided by the Pillars of our 2022-26 Strategic Plan, as well as a focus on equity, fiscal responsibility, and local control.

Academic Excellence

Students' academic achievement is essential to forming a meaningful path to college and career. A culture of academic achievement and high expectations spurs student curiosity and engagement and prepares students to participate in civil society and democracy. As the echoes of COVID-19 pandemic resound, the State must continue to advance efforts to address learning loss and chronic absenteeism. In alignment with our Strategic Plan, we will support efforts that allow us to improve student performance and graduation rates, so that all students graduate ready for the world.

Joy and Wellness

Student health and wellbeing is at the core of everything we do as a district. All policies we sponsor or support must serve our students' ability to learn, grow, and thrive in a safe environment that helps them achieve their greatest potential as scholars and citizens. As part of this effort, we will support policies that are consistent with the principles of educational equity and that prioritize access to limited resources in areas of highest need.

Engagement and Collaboration

Building trust among internal and external community partners is a critical step in supporting the needs of students. Los Angeles Unified stands committed to strengthening communication with

parents and outside partners on the District's advocacy efforts, and to solicit support on advocacy priorities where coalition efforts are warranted.

Operational Effectiveness and Investing in Staff

As the second largest employer in Los Angeles County and second largest public education system in the country, Los Angeles Unified is committed to ensuring the organizational sustainability of the school district by supporting an educator and staff pipeline of highly qualified and diverse personnel. We will advocate for administrative flexibilities that allow the District to prioritize positions that support services for the whole child.

Fiscal Responsibility

Recognizing that California has a requirement to present a balanced budget, we will holistically consider how requests for increased state or federal funding for certain programs may impact other District advocacy priorities. We believe that it is important that the State fund any new mandates or requirements that it places on school districts. As a large and diverse district, we value flexibility in funding and protecting the principles of the Local Control Funding Formula. We will continue to advocate for sustainable, ongoing funding that allows the District to invest in our students, staff, and families over the long term.

Local Control

Los Angeles Unified is a unique district within California and the United States. Our student body is four times larger than the next largest district in the State and offers services "in-house" that in most districts are supported by the County Office of Education. We recognize and respect that each district serves a unique population and faces unique challenges. For that reason, we value local control and local discretion to provide services and administer programs according to local student needs wherever possible.

AREAS OF FOCUS

Adequacy of Funding

Serving students requires investing in a full and fair funding strategy that includes investments in preschool through Adult Education. The Legislature should consider that costs, such as health insurance and housing, are rising far above the rate of inflation, meaning an annual cost-of-living-adjustment (COLA) is often insufficient. We will continue to advocate for California to join most states in funding schools based on student enrollment, rather than attendance, which more accurately reflects the fixed costs of serving students. Further, the state legislature should prioritize the reimbursements of costly mandated activities that result in less discretionary funding for school sites and the classroom. The State must also continue its commitment to adequately reimburse local educational agencies for the closure of schools due to emergencies including, but not limited to, natural disasters.

Adult Education

Adult Education provides learning opportunities and employment training to adults and out-of-school teens to prepare them for post-secondary studies, careers, and civic participation. To expand and improve services to effectively meet the needs of adult learners, we will

support state policies that provide flexibility to meet changing workforce needs and increase community access to adult education programs and services.

Charter Schools

We support legislative efforts that support all authorizers in the state to advance strong oversight, particularly in the areas of academic achievement, governance, and fiscal transparency, as well as accountability for charter school operations, and equity and access for all students. As the largest authorizer in the State, we believe charter authorizers across the state need to receive ongoing levels of support to implement effective oversight.

Curriculum and Instruction

Robust instructional supports are essential contributors to student success. We will advocate for state support of curriculum and instructional practices by ensuring that sufficient resources are available to effectively implement new and existing curriculum requirements and practices. The State should promote the development of robust curriculum frameworks and additions integrated into existing frameworks, while remaining mindful of the impact that new curriculum requirements have on graduation rates, student enrichment opportunities, and the ability of local school boards to design a curriculum that meets local needs and preferences. In addition, the COVID-19 pandemic created new ways of working and learning. We support efforts to maintain and expand access to online tutoring, coursework, and other digital resources.

Before and After School Care

With the creation of the Expanded Learning Opportunities Program, school districts can better support working families and expand learning opportunities for students, including access to arts, music, sports, enrichment activities, and field trips that would be otherwise out of reach for many families. We are committed to continuing to strengthen before- and after-school program coherence, quality, developmental appropriateness, and accessibility. We will advocate for increased, dedicated support for before- and after-school programming, as well as additional flexibilities that will allow us to best serve our diverse student body.

Data-Driven Practices

Academic achievement and post-secondary success can be achieved most readily when targeted instruction and intervention are guided by real-time, multiple-measure data, both qualitative and quantitative, across transitions from pre-kindergarten to elementary; elementary to middle; middle to high school; and high school to college or career. The State should invest in and support local education agencies' ability to monitor effectiveness and guide technical assistance. We believe that the State should hold schools accountable for metrics that are actionable and should avoid penalizing districts or creating the perception of poor performance for activities or outcomes out of their control. When the State identifies schools to receive additional assistance, the State should also provide timely and transparent policies for how schools will exit this identification for support.

Digital Equity and Safety

Access to high-speed and reliable internet has proven to be a necessity—not a luxury—allowing students, families, and businesses to access valuable information online to continue instruction, stay socially connected, and complete daily work. The digital divide is especially harmful to public education in low-income communities and communities of color which are disproportionately

impacted, leaving the highest-need families disconnected. The State recently adopted a Digital Equity Bill of Rights and must go further to ensure that these principles are translated into action by supporting affordable, reliable, high-speed broadband, and by building out middle-mile and last-mile infrastructure to underserved areas. We also recognize that technologies can negatively affect student health, safety, and wellness. Both State and Federal governments must enhance social media safety and protect students from social media-related dangers including cyberbullying, hate speech, sexual harassment, and propaganda. We are attentive to both the opportunities and challenges inherent to the rise of Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) and with the understanding it will bring both, will be a voice for students as any state guidelines, policies or regulations are developed.

Early Childhood Education

High-quality pre-kindergarten and transitional kindergarten programs improve a child's social-emotional development and lead to stronger mathematics and literacy skills. Los Angeles Unified is committed to providing every student with a quality education and believes in laying the foundation early to prepare children for kindergarten and beyond. We will support policies that expand access to high-quality early learning for children ages 0-5, including, but not limited to, increased subsidized childcare slots, and greater supports to increase the quality and preparation of the workforce. The State must ensure that new or more stringent program requirements are funded before those requirements are implemented, and that districts are provided sufficient time and resources to implement any new requirements such as smaller class size ratios and increased teacher qualifications.

English Learners and Language Acquisition

Throughout Los Angeles Unified, over 94,000 English Learners are learning to speak English proficiently. Sixty percent of our students live in a home where a language other than English is spoken. English Learners include both newcomer students who immigrate from other countries as well as students born in the US to families who speak languages other than English. We will support policies that allow our English Learners to acquire English fluency and reclassify as English proficient while maintaining their home language and graduating college- and career-ready with the California Seal of Biliteracy. We will seek to expand dual language education programming and offer world language classes that reflect the diversity of our district, and to provide multilingual pathways for all students to become bilingual and biliterate.

Federal Policies

With the support of our federal advocates, we will continue to monitor and advocate through the annual appropriations cycle for increased funding of Titles I-IV formula programs; federal grant programs such as the Magnet Schools Assistance (MSA) grant; and 21st Century program funds for after-school programs. In addition, we will actively advocate for full funding of the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act (IDEA); passage of federal legislation to fund schools' physical and digital infrastructure, including school greening projects; the repeal of the Government Pension Offset/Windfall Elimination Provision and increased funding to state and local education agencies under the McKinney-Vento Homeless Assistance Act. We will support a permanent solution for undocumented youth and Temporary Protected Status (TPS) beneficiaries, the end of immigration policies that impact learning and family stability, and common-sense gun reform. In

addition to these priorities, we will support federal legislation that is consistent with other policies and principles outlined in this document, as appropriate.

Post-Secondary Attainment and Success

Los Angeles Unified is committed to preparing all students for postsecondary success by supporting state policies that enable us to align innovative resources equitably and effectively in support of student needs. College readiness curriculum, providing access to the financial aid application process, and concurrent enrollment at secondary school sites builds students' identity as college and career ready. We will support policies that remove barriers to college access for all students, especially those from underrepresented communities.

School Facilities

With over 1,300 schools serving pre-kindergarten through Adult Education, Los Angeles Unified's aging and deteriorated school facilities require ongoing investments to provide safe, healthy, and functional places to learn for all students. We are still making up for decades of unmet capital needs, while new requirements and priorities emerge, and the backlog of unaddressed conditions continues to grow. Our capital needs far exceed the funding available. We are committed to pursuing and supporting changes to state law that will maximize funding, address barriers to timely project execution, ensure efficient use of resources, and promote the District's climate goals including the transition to renewable energy. We support statewide investments in school facilities construction, modernization, and greening projects, and will pursue actions that enable us to upgrade our solar power system to achieve 100 percent clean renewable energy by 2030.

School Personnel Pipeline

With the ongoing need to create a pipeline of credentialed math and science teachers, nurses, psychiatric social workers, librarians, and other classified positions, we will continue to advocate for programs that expand career ladders, both pre-service and in-service, and draw highly effective candidates into the field of education. These efforts include funding for teacher preparation programs, higher education collaboratives between districts and institutions of higher education, and research practice partnerships.

Special Education

Special education is significantly underfunded in California and across the nation. The share of District's General Fund contribution directed to special education is more than double the State or federal share. We believe the State and federal governments need to increase their investment levels to enhance equitable special education funding for pre-kindergarten students with disabilities and students with moderate-to-severe disabilities. We will continue to support federal funding efforts to match the initial principles of the IDEA to fund special education at the appropriate level. Finally, we will support the principles of inclusiveness and inclusive terminology.

State Mandates

The passage of state legislation often results in new, unfunded mandates that local educational agencies pay out of the existing state funding received through the Local Control Funding Formula. With the passage of new legislation, the state legislature should prioritize the reimbursements of costly mandated activities that result in less discretionary funding for school sites and the classroom. The State must meet its obligations to reimburse school districts for prior mandate

claims and should develop a clear and public process for the funding of future state-mandated activities – either through the constitutional claim process, or inclusion in the K-12 Mandate Block Grant Program. For example, while we will endeavor to meet and exceed the state requirement that all new school buses purchased be electric beginning 2035, we will continue to engage the State to fund costs accompanying the associated new mandate.

Student Safety

Student safety is the Los Angeles Unified School District's number one priority. The District takes a strong position against bullying, hazing, or any behavior that infringes on the safety or well-being of students, employees, or any other persons within the District's jurisdiction or interferes with learning or the ability to teach. We will collaborate with local authorities, such as the City of Los Angeles and the County of Los Angeles, to support safe passage to and from school for students, staff, and families. We will advocate for full funding for crossing guards and traffic calming measures that reduce pedestrian-related incidents. As our nation faces an unprecedented threat to our youth in synthetic opioid overdose risk, we will support efforts at all levels of government to address this crisis. We will also advocate for new avenues to curtail the pervasive epidemic of gun violence through new legislative requirements, including, but not limited to, strengthening gun violence restraining orders, gun storage laws and, restrictions of the sale of firearms, and increased safety measures.

Supporting the Whole Child

Supporting the whole child is grounded on the principle that each student's potential for success is positively influenced by an environment that fosters the health, mental health, safety, engagement, support, and academic enrichment of that student. Students learn best when we recognize that academic achievement is not limited to experiences in the classroom. Accordingly, we will continue to advocate for whole-child well-being, including, but not limited to, expanding services for the health and wellness of students through Medi-Cal and other funding mechanisms. We will continue expanding our network of medical, mental, and behavioral health services through internal and external providers. We will continue to expand access to sustainable funding for provision of school meals that meet federal and state nutritional standards and support measures that contribute access to affordable housing for students, families, and school employees.